

Alistair O'Brien

Osaka, Japan

alistair.m.obrien@gmail.com | <https://jp.linkedin.com/in/alistair-o-brien>

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior game/tools programmer with experience across Unity, C#, tools development, game systems architecture, console porting, production workflows, and technical art. Strong focus on building practical tools and pipelines that reduce friction for designers, artists, programmers, and other collaborators. Shipped work spans PC, Nintendo Switch, PlayStation, Xbox, Android, Web.

CORE SKILLS

- Programming: C#, Unity, Python
- Game development: Core Gameplay Architecture, Combat Systems, UI Frameworks, Animation Tooling, Procedural Generation, Localization, Debug/Diagnostics Tooling
- Platforms: Windows, macOS, iOS, Android, web, Nintendo Switch, PlayStation, Xbox
- Production: Project Scheduling, Budgeting, Publisher Communications, Workflow Design, Dev Ops

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Skeleton Crew Studio - Senior Programmer

Kyoto, Japan | October 2019 - Present

- Built game systems architecture, internal tools, and production workflows across games, VR, web, experimental experiences, and non-game projects.
- Led workflow optimization and tool development efforts to ensure designers and artists had minimum friction when implementing their visions.
- Contributed to console porting work, including graphics optimization, memory management, CPU performance, input, and platform-specific compliance.
- Led production and project management through scheduling, budgeting, and efficient communication processes.

Selected projects:

- Forestrike - Lead Programmer / Producer, Unity, C#, Python, Windows, Nintendo Switch
 - Designed project schedule, budget, milestone structure, and development workflow for a martial arts roguelite published by Devolver Digital.
 - Built a custom Aseprite importer and combat animation sequencer for designer-authored combat behavior.
 - Created designer-facing player technique tooling.
 - Designed a localization system which favored in context editing and enabled late-stage localization kit export.
 - Built an asset-driven audio layer with audio designer friendly parameters which reduced manual AudioSource management.
 - Set up remote build deployment systems and workflows to ensure rapid testing processes were non interrupting.
 - Optimized the Nintendo Switch version for graphics, memory, CPU bottlenecks, and implemented correct authentication processes for independent server communication.
- Olija - Programmer, Unity, C#, Construct 2, Windows, Nintendo Switch, PlayStation, Xbox
 - Supported multi-platform porting.
 - Documented and automated platform build processes.
 - Built debug overlays and investigated niche platform-specific bugs.

Active Gaming Media - Programmer

Osaka, Japan | March 2018 - October 2019

- Worked in a small in-house game development department using Unity and C#.
- Led a team of roughly eight developers, with emphasis on project management and smoother development workflows.
- Developed tools and Unity systems to support production needs and reduce repeated manual work.

Scarlet City Studios - Programmer / 3D Artist

Auckland, New Zealand | December 2013 - July 2017

- Started as a 3D and texture artist, moved into technical art, then transitioned into programming.
- Created hand-painted low-poly game assets using Blender, Photoshop, and Unity.
- Built mobile-friendly shaders for vertex animation, color remapping, and ambient effects.
- Implemented combat system frontend work, quest content, and game designer tools for animation timelines.

Selected project:

- The Aetherlight - Programmer / 3D Artist, Unity, C#, Java, Blender, Photoshop, Windows, macOS, iOS, Android, web
 - Contributed 3D art, technical art, shader work, combat tooling, and frontend gameplay programming.

EDUCATION

Auckland University of Technology

Auckland, New Zealand | Bachelor of Art and Design, Digital Design | 2011 - 2013

- Graduated as Head of School.